# Schoology Grade Tracker: Launch Readiness Analysis & Plan

Oct 21, 2026 · @Tae

## Executive summary

Goal: a public alpha/beta by **Fri Nov 13, 2026** (3.5 weeks from today). That means a product website, a working app that testers install from Google Play (closed testing) and Apple TestFlight, and a production backend kept separate from development.

The app is a privacy-first grades tracker for students on iOS and Android, built in React Native + Expo, with an optional Supabase cloud account. The core is built and tested: the grade engine, the offline gradebook, manual class entry, forecasts, semester grades and sync all work in development (111 automated tests pass). What is missing is almost all **launch** work. Nothing is published to a store, there is no website or privacy policy, and one Supabase project acts as both development and production.

**Verdict: launchable in the window if launch work moves ahead of the two import features.** Screenshot import (F04) and saved-report import (F05) are the biggest remaining features. They ship to testers in a later beta build, not on launch day.

## Where we are now

As of Oct 21, **9 of the 14 MVP features work in development builds** (Expo Go and web). Milestone M1 (core app) shipped on time in week 2. Manual entry (T2.1) also merged on Oct 19.

| Feature | State today | Evidence |
|---|---|---|
| F01 Onboarding / Welcome | Done | Welcome screen, use without account |
| F02 Grades home, F03 Course detail | Done | Home + Grades tabs, periods → categories → assignments |
| F06 Manual entry | Done | Course, category and assignment forms (PR #8) |

| Feature | State today | Evidence |
|---|---|---|
| F07 Grade engine | Done | On-device TypeScript engine matches server SQL; unit tests |
| F08 What-If / forecasts | Done | Forecast screen; projected vs current grade |
| F10 Semester grades | Done | Semesters section on course detail |
| F12 Light/dark theme | Done | Theme preference in Settings |
| F13 Offline storage | Done | SQLite on the phone |
| F14 Opt-in cloud sync | Done, not yet tested phone-to-phone | Revision-based push/pull, tombstones, Realtime refresh |
| F09 Final-grade calculator | Engine done, **no screen** | `requiredScore()` exists; not wired to UI |
| F11 Upcoming (iCal feed) | **Placeholder** | Tab shows sample data; "Coming soon" on refresh |
| F04 Screenshot import (OCR) | **Not started** | "Coming soon" button |
| F05 Saved-report import | **Not started** | "Coming soon" button |

**Backend.** One Supabase project (PostgreSQL + Auth) holds 6 migrations, row-level security on every table, and SQL tests that pass. Sign-in: email and Google (Google OAuth is still in "testing" mode, my account only).

**Launch readiness: close to zero.** There is no `eas.json` and no iOS bundle ID or Android package name. There are no store developer accounts and no release build. There is no website, no privacy policy (the Settings "Privacy" row is a placeholder), no in-app account deletion, no crash reporting and no CI. The single Supabase project is both dev and "prod".

## Where we need to be (launch definition)

Launch = a stranger can find the product, install it on their own phone, use it with real grades, and lose nothing when we ship an update. Four deliverables:

1. **Public product page.** A one-page site on a custom domain: what it does, screenshots, "Join the beta" links for iOS and Android, a privacy policy, terms, an account-deletion page and a support email.
2. **Viable MVP in the stores.**
   - Android: Google Play **closed testing** track, opt-in link, 12+ testers.
   - iOS: **TestFlight external testing**, public link (up to 10,000 testers).
   - Viable means the student can get their real grades in by hand, trust the grade, plan the final, see what's due, and optionally sync. Every visible button works; no "Coming soon" dead ends on launch day.
3. **Production backend.** A dedicated production Supabase project. Schema changes reach it only through reviewed, versioned migrations on a release, never by hand.
4. **A separate development environment.** A second Supabase project and its own app build profile. New features are built and tested there, and testers never touch it.

The launch build is **v0.9.0 "Beta 1"**. Screenshot import (F04) and saved-report import (F05) follow in **Beta 2** before the Dec 4 dev cutoff.

## Gap analysis

The launch work adds up to about **12 base hours (≈18 planned)**. Planned capacity from now to Nov 13 is about 11.5 hours (college-app and tournament weeks). It fits only because I have run ahead of plan: M1, sync and manual entry, planned through Oct 16, were all merged by Oct 19. So launch work replaces the import work the original plan had for these weeks, and F11 is the first thing cut if I fall behind.

| Requirement | Today | Work needed | Base hrs | Risk |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Developer accounts | None | Apple Developer Program ($99/yr), Google Play Console ($25 once), identity checks | 0.5 | **High.** Approval takes days; both programs expect an adult account holder |
| App identity | Name "Grade Tracker", no IDs | Final name, bundle ID / package name, icon, store screenshots | 1.0 | Medium. "Schoology" cannot be in the store name |

| Requirement | Today | Work needed | Base hrs | Risk |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Release builds | Expo Go only | `eas.json` profiles, signing, first Android + iOS builds | 1.5 | Medium. First native build often hits config errors |
| Product page | None | One-page site, privacy policy, terms, delete-account page | 2.0 | Low |
| Separate dev / prod backend | One Supabase project | Second project, Supabase CLI migrations, GitHub Action for releases | 2.0 | Medium |
| Store compliance | Missing | In-app account deletion, Sign in with Apple, Data safety and privacy labels, Google OAuth out of "testing" | 2.0 | Medium |
| F09 final-grade screen | Engine only | Screen on course detail | 0.5 | Low |
| F11 Upcoming from iCal | Placeholder | Feed URL in Settings, fetch + parse, match to courses | 1.0 | Medium. Some school feeds need a CORS-free fetch, so native only |
| Two-phone QA + bug fixes | Not done | Checklist on 1 iPhone + 1 Android | 1.0 | Low |
| Feedback + crash reporting | None | Feedback form link in Settings, Sentry (free tier) | 0.5 | Low |
| **Total** | | | **≈ 12** | |

**Deferred to Beta 2 (Nov 16 – Dec 4):** F04 screenshot OCR (4.5 planned hrs) and F05 saved-report import (3.0 planned hrs).

# Research findings

The research changes the plan in four places: who owns the store accounts, Google's 14-day test rule, Sign in with Apple, and the product name.

## Store rules that shape the schedule

- **Account holder age.** Google Play Console requires the account holder to be at least 18 (Google). Apple's individual enrollment also expects an adult. If I am under 18, a parent enrolls both accounts and adds me as a team member. Start this week; identity checks take days.
- **Google's 12-tester rule.** New personal Play accounts must run a closed test with **at least 12 testers opted in for 14 days in a row** before Production unlocks (Google). The closed test itself is the beta, so it does not block launch. A Nov 6 closed-test start makes a public Play listing possible about Nov 20.
- **TestFlight.** External testing allows up to 10,000 testers by email or public link. The first build needs Beta App Review (usually 1–2 days), and builds expire after 90 days (Apple).
- **Sign in with Apple.** Guideline 4.8 says an app that offers Google sign-in must also offer a login that collects only name and email and lets the user hide their email. Sign in with Apple meets this (Apple guidelines). The paid Apple account that blocked this on Oct 9 is needed for TestFlight anyway.
- **Account deletion.** Apple 5.1.1(v) requires in-app deletion when an app creates accounts. Google requires in-app deletion **and** a web link entered in the Data safety form (Google).
- **Privacy policy.** Both stores require a public URL, linked inside the app too. It must list data collected, third parties (Supabase, Google sign-in, Sentry), retention, and how to delete.
- **Name.** Apple 4.1(c) and 5.2.1 prohibit using another company's brand in the app name without approval, and Schoology belongs to PowerSchool. The store name stays brand-free; the description may say "works with Schoology grade pages".

## Student privacy

- Audience is **13 and up** (high school), declared in both stores. That keeps the app out of COPPA parental-consent rules and Google's Families policy.
- FERPA binds schools, not an app a student chooses. Still, the app never asks for a Schoology password: grades come from what the student types or imports.

- The private iCal feed URL acts like a password. It stays on the phone and is never synced.

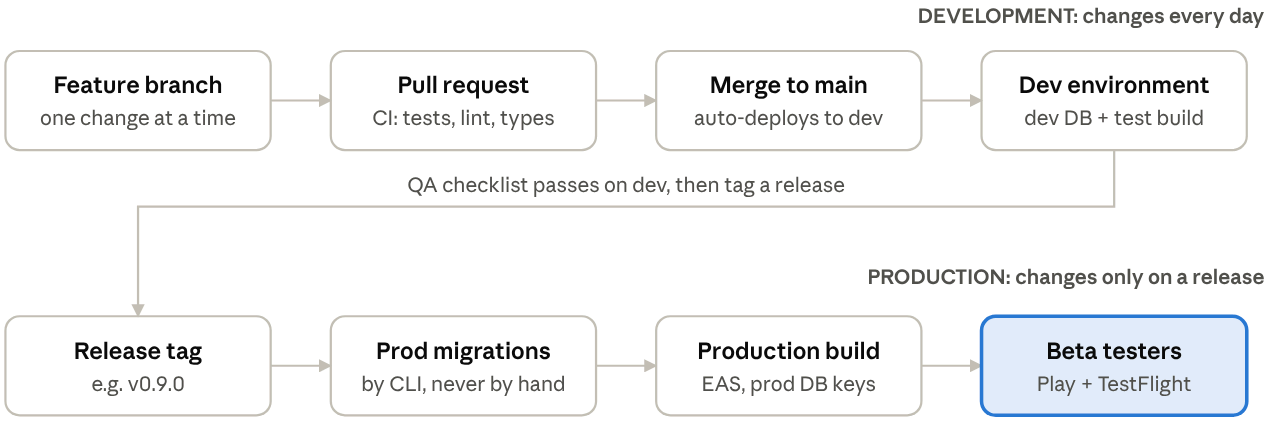
### Hosting and cost

| Item | Choice | Cost |
|---|---|---|
| Apple Developer Program | Individual (parent if under 18) | $99 / year |
| Google Play Console | Personal | $25 once |
| Domain | e.g. a .app domain | ≈ $15 / year |
| Product page | GitHub Pages or Vercel, from `website/` in the repo | $0 |
| Backend | Supabase Free: 2 projects (dev + prod); paused after 1 week idle | $0 |
| Builds | EAS Free: 15 Android + 15 iOS builds / month | $0 |
| Crash reports | Sentry free tier | $0 |
| **Total to launch** | | **≈ $139** |

The app works offline, so a paused prod project would stop only sync. A weekly GitHub Action ping keeps it awake. Upgrading prod to Supabase Pro ($25/month) is the fix once real users depend on it (Supabase pricing).

## Environments and release process

Two fully separate environments: **dev** changes daily, **prod** changes only when I cut a tagged release.




release flow · dev and prod environments

| | Development | Production |
|---|---|---|
| Supabase project | `gradetracker-dev` | `gradetracker-prod` |
| Who uses it | Me + 2 friends on test builds | Beta testers |
| App build | EAS `development` / `preview` profile | EAS `production` profile |
| Store track | Play internal testing | Play closed testing, TestFlight external |
| Schema changes | `supabase db push` on every merge to `main` | Same migration files, only on a release tag |
| Data | Seed / sample data, can be reset | Real student data, never reset |
| Google OAuth redirect | Dev project callback | Prod project callback |

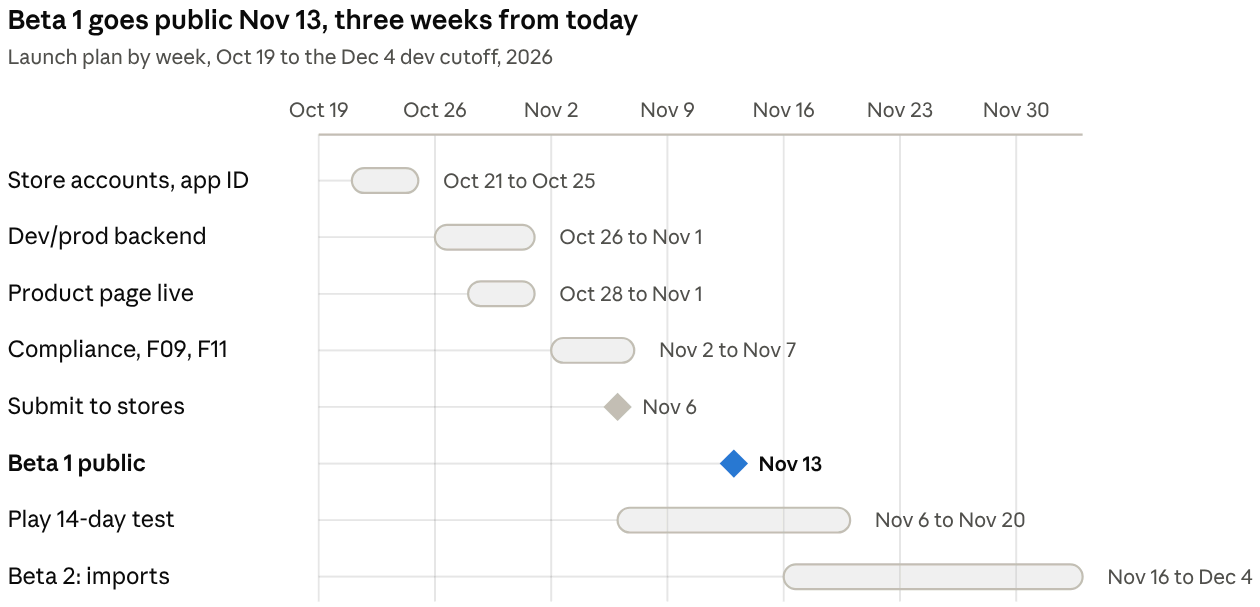
### Rules for the live backend

1. Every schema change is a new file in `supabase/migrations/`. No edits in the Supabase dashboard on prod.
2. Migrations only add things during the beta (new columns nullable, new tables). Nothing renamed or dropped while an older app version can still call it.
3. A release runs the SQL tests against dev first, then pushes the same migrations to prod. A GitHub Action holds the prod database password, not my laptop.

4. Prod has daily backups (Supabase Free keeps them). Before each release I also take a manual `pg_dump`.
5. Version numbers: `0.9.x` for Beta 1 fixes, `0.10.0` for Beta 2 (imports). JavaScript-only fixes can go out by EAS Update on the `production` channel; anything native needs a new store build.

## Week-by-week plan

Beta 1 reaches public testers on **Fri Nov 13**; Beta 2 adds the import features by the Dec 4 dev cutoff.




launch timeline · Oct 21 – Dec 4, 2026

### Week A · Oct 21 – 25 · accounts and identity (≈ 2 hrs, college-app week)

- [ ] Enroll Apple Developer Program and Google Play Console (parent as account holder if needed)
- [ ] Pick the final store name (no "Schoology"), buy the domain, make a support email
- [ ] Set iOS bundle ID and Android package name in `app.json`; add `eas.json` with `development`, `preview`, `production` profiles
- [ ] Create the second Supabase project; rename projects to `gradetracker-dev` and `gradetracker-prod`
- [ ] Recruit 15+ testers (classmates, App Innovation class) for Google's 12-tester minimum

### Week B · Oct 26 – Nov 1 · environments and product page (≈ 2.5 hrs, college-app week)

- [ ] Supabase CLI linked to both projects; GitHub Action: tests on every PR, `db push` to dev on merge, to prod on a `v*` tag
- [ ] Build config reads dev or prod Supabase keys per EAS profile (EAS environment variables)
- [ ] First Android `preview` build on Play internal testing; first iOS build on TestFlight internal
- [ ] Product page live: hero, 3 screenshots, "Join the beta" buttons, privacy policy, terms, delete-account page

### Week C · Nov 2 – 8 · viable MVP and store submission (≈ 5 hrs, full week)

- [ ] In-app "Delete my account" (Supabase function that removes the user and all rows)
- [ ] Sign in with Apple on iOS; Google OAuth consent screen moved from testing to production
- [ ] F09 final-grade screen on course detail; F11 iCal feed in Settings and Upcoming tab
- [ ] Replace every "Coming soon" button: hide import buttons until Beta 2; Privacy row opens the policy
- [ ] Sentry crash reporting and a feedback form link in Settings
- [ ] Two-phone QA checklist on dev (iPhone + Android, airplane mode, sync)
- [ ] Tag **v0.9.0**: prod migrations, production builds, Play closed test opened (by Fri Nov 6), TestFlight external submitted for Beta App Review

### Week D · Nov 9 – 13 · Beta 1 public (≈ 2.5 hrs, tournament week)

- [ ] TestFlight public link and Play opt-in link added to the product page
- [ ] Onboard testers; watch Sentry and feedback daily; ship v0.9.x fixes
- [ ] **Fri Nov 13: Beta 1 live**

### After launch · Nov 16 – Dec 4

- [ ] F04 screenshot import and F05 saved-report import built on dev, released as **v0.10.0 (Beta 2)**
- [ ] About Nov 20: 14-day closed test complete → apply for Play production access
- [ ] Final QA pass and release builds for the demo (original M4)

# Risks and cut list

The biggest risk is waiting on other people (account approvals and app review), not code. That is why accounts start this week.

| Risk | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|---|
| Apple or Google enrollment is slow, or needs a parent as account holder | Medium | Blocks that store | Enroll Oct 21–22; parent ready with ID. Android and iOS are independent, so one can launch without the other |
| TestFlight Beta App Review rejects the build (login rules, privacy link, placeholder buttons) | Medium | iOS slips 2–4 days | Sign in with Apple, account deletion and the policy link in before submitting; submit by Nov 6, a week of slack |
| Fewer than 12 Android testers stay opted in | Medium | Delays public Play listing, not the beta | Recruit 15+; send the opt-in link in class |
| First native build fails (signing, plugins, SQLite) | Medium | 1–2 days | First build in Week B, far from the deadline |
| Hours lost to college apps (Nov 1 / Nov 15 deadlines) and the S&D tournament | High | Whole plan | Cut list below; launch tasks are small and independent |
| Bad migration hits real student data | Low | Severe | Rules in the environments section: CLI only, additive changes, test on dev first, backup before each release |
| Free Supabase prod project pauses after 7 idle days | Medium | Sync stops; app still works offline | Weekly keep-alive Action; Pro plan once testers depend on it |

**Cut list, in order, if Week C runs long:**

1. F11 Upcoming from iCal → hide the tab for Beta 1, ship in Beta 2.
2. iOS on launch day → Android-first Beta 1; iOS joins when TestFlight review clears.

3. Sentry → rely on the feedback form for Beta 1.

**Never cut:** the dev/prod split, account deletion, the privacy policy and the product page. Those are the launch requirements themselves.

## Success criteria and this week's review

Beta 1 counts as launched when all of these are true on Nov 13:

- [ ] Searching the product name finds the product page, with working iOS and Android beta links
- [ ] At least **12 Android testers** opted in to the Play closed test and at least **5 iOS testers** on TestFlight
- [ ] A tester who never saw the app can install it, enter a real class by hand and see a grade that matches Schoology, with no help from me
- [ ] Production and development run on separate Supabase projects; prod has changed only through tagged migrations
- [ ] At least 99% of sessions crash-free in Sentry, and no open P0 bug
- [ ] Deleting an account in the app removes all of that student's cloud data

**Ready to show in this week's review:** the app running from a dev build with the 9 working features, this plan, the release-flow diagram, and proof that the store enrollments and domain purchase have started.

**Decisions I need from you:** whether a Play closed test plus TestFlight public link counts as "available in the store" for this assignment, and whether a parent may hold the developer accounts.

## Sources

Looked up Oct 21, 2026.

- App Store Review Guidelines (4.1(c), 4.8, 5.1.1, 5.2.1)
- TestFlight overview, App Store Connect Help
- Google Play: testing requirements for new personal developer accounts
- Google Play: account deletion requirements
- Google Play Console: account sign-up (18+)
- Supabase pricing

- Expo EAS plans
- Project repo: `docs/mvp.md`, `docs/project-plan/`, `docs/weekly-status/2026-10-09.md`